

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - August 10, 2026 (Part 1)

Compiled summary for Monday, August 10, 2026 - Part 1 - focus: resuming the Prah.dev Portfolio project from the refreshed snapshot and prior PDF worklogs, running the local Next.js site at <http://127.0.0.1:3000>, diagnosing apparently missing Alla Vostra UI Foundations assets, advising the Controls & Inputs state-catalog strategy, rebuilding the Alla Vostra Visual Hierarchy section around real framed startup-device imagery, generating a muted lower-screen Focal Point variant, adding TT Fors annotations, validating TypeScript and browser-rendered measurements, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, reviewing all prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, and generating the August 10 Part 1 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after `portfolio_worklog_august6.pdf` and after the August 6 documentation state, including the current committed source state `c496a04` on main, which matched origin/main before this PDF was generated. No new Hostinger production deployment, GitHub Actions dispatch, or public-site publish was performed during this record. The only local source change left after the final snapshot refresh was `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`, and this PDF was produced as the requested August 10 Part 1 documentation artifact.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Ran `./read_project.sh` from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio` and regenerated `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio documentation work.
- Reviewed the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`, including project notes, source tree, public image and font inventories, PDF worklog inventory, package and deployment configuration, git context, recent commits, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF:
`portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf`,
`portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf`,
`portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf`,
`portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july22.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july23.pdf`,
`portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july29.pdf`,
`portfolio_worklog_july30.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july31.pdf`,
`portfolio_worklog_august1_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august1_part2.pdf`,
`portfolio_worklog_august1_part3.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf`,
`portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august5.pdf`, and
`portfolio_worklog_august6.pdf`.
- Extracted text from all twenty-two existing Portfolio PDFs with `pdftotext` and checked recent metadata with `pdftinfo` to preserve title cadence, Part 1 naming, opening-summary density, section order, bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched lists, local-only deployment language, root-level filename style, letter-size pages, PDF 1.4 output, Codex author/creator/producer metadata, and Helvetica-style base-font convention.

- Used portfolio_worklog_august6.pdf as the closest structural baseline because it documented the immediately preceding UI Foundations, screenshot-preview, transparent-asset, product-flow navigation, Overview media, and Controls & Inputs work around the same Alla Vostra case-study page.
- Reviewed current git state through git status, git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, git diff --stat, git diff --name-status, and git diff --check. The current source commit reviewed for the Visual Hierarchy work was c496a04, with the regenerated snapshot carrying the latest timestamp and public image inventory updates.
- Reviewed app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, app/globals.css, public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-framed.png, public/images/startup_screen_large.png, public/images/startup_screen_small.png, the generated lower-muted startup-frame asset, package scripts, and the local Next.js route at /projects/alla-vostra.

Baseline Status Before August 10 Part 1 Work

- The August 6 Portfolio work had already rebuilt large parts of the Alla Vostra UI Foundations and UX Product Flow system, including sticky view switching, universal screenshot magnification, transparent preview behavior, real Play Store media, transparent-bgless navigation and control crops, and final Controls & Inputs high/low-visibility state stacks.
- The current project needed re-orientation before edits continued, so the working cycle began by running the project snapshot script and reading all root-level snapshot and worklog materials.
- The local development server needed to be available at http://127.0.0.1:3000 so the user could inspect the Portfolio page and direct visual changes live.
- Several UI Foundations assets appeared not to show in the browser, especially in the Navigations section. The files existed on disk and the rendered URLs returned 200 responses, so the issue needed to be separated from an actual missing-asset problem.
- The Controls & Inputs section already had meaningful before/after state samples, but the user wanted product guidance on whether tapped/untapped versions and every individual app button belonged in the UI Foundations presentation.
- The Visual Hierarchy category still used placeholder frames and did not yet communicate a concrete design-system idea through real Alla Vostra app screenshots, real device frames, or annotated viewing/focal-area comparisons.
- The user wanted the Visual Hierarchy previews to reference the existing Original Hero asset scale under Iconography & Imagery rather than becoming a separate oversized device-preview system.

Goals for August 10 Part 1

- Resume the Portfolio project context by studying all existing snapshots and worklogs, then keep later edits consistent with the established Alla Vostra UI Foundations direction.
- Run the local Portfolio site at http://127.0.0.1:3000 and keep browser validation anchored to the actual rendered page rather than source-only assumptions.
- Diagnose the apparently missing UI Foundations assets without renaming or deleting public image files unnecessarily.
- Advise the user on a sustainable Controls & Inputs documentation strategy: show meaningful state pairs and distinct interaction patterns, not every repeated button instance.
- Replace Visual Hierarchy placeholders with real framed Alla Vostra startup-device previews while keeping the rest of the UI Foundations layout stable.

- Create a second Visual Hierarchy preview that keeps the full screen visible but deemphasizes the non-focal lower screen area at 50% opacity.
- Add clear TT Fors labels for Viewing Area and Focal Point, position them using the sticky cart button as the bottom edge for the lower text area, and scale the labels to the user-approved prominence.
- Validate the final visual state with TypeScript and Playwright browser measurements, then generate the August 10 Part 1 PDF worklog in the established format.

Work Completed - Project Orientation and Local Preview

- Ran `./read_project.sh` at the start of the session, generated a fresh `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`, and reviewed the snapshot context before continuing user-directed page work.
- Located and studied every existing Portfolio PDF worklog, covering the July 11 initial portfolio setup through the August 6 UI Foundations and product-flow refinement pass.
- Started the Next.js development server with `npm run dev -- --hostname 127.0.0.1 --port 3000` and confirmed Next.js 16.2.10 reported ready at the requested local address.
- Kept the local server running through the visual-edit sequence, restarting it once after a stale stylesheet check showed that the browser was not yet applying a newly added CSS selector.
- Used Playwright repeatedly against `http://127.0.0.1:3000/projects/alla-vostra` to switch into UI Foundations, scroll to target categories, measure rendered element sizes, inspect image URLs, and capture verification screenshots.

Work Completed - Asset Diagnosis and Controls Advice

- Investigated the apparently missing Navigation assets by checking `public/images/alla-vostra/ui-assets` and transparent-bgless counterparts, then confirmed the expected files existed on disk.
- Queried the local server with `curl` and confirmed the real transparent-bgless asset URLs returned 200 OK, while intentionally nonexistent navigation-header-cta-before paths returned 404 and were not the paths used by the component.
- Used Playwright to inspect the rendered `img` elements in the Navigations section and confirmed there were no failed image requests, normal opacity, valid `_next/image` URLs, and loaded natural image dimensions.
- Identified the visual problem as a presentation/cache/contrast issue rather than a missing-folder issue: transparent button crops and dark surrounding frames could appear ghosted against the dark gridded UI Foundations background, especially in a stale browser tab.
- Advised that Controls & Inputs should include tapped/untapped or before/after versions only when the state teaches a real interaction rule, such as Default, Added, Enabled, Disabled, Active, Inactive, or Destructive.
- Advised against featuring every single Alla Vostra button instance, recommending that UI Foundations document distinct button patterns and interaction responsibilities rather than becoming an exhaustive screenshot inventory.

Work Completed - Visual Hierarchy Frame System

- Scoped the Visual Hierarchy category so it no longer inherited the default Small plus Large placeholder pair for every step.
- Iterated the user-directed frame selection: first removing small frames, then reversing to small-only, then making Step 1 Large while Steps 2 through 5 remained Small placeholders.

- Extended PlaceholderScreen in ProductFlowSwitcher so it can accept class names, inline frame styles, image sources, image styles, outer sizing, overlay labels, and overlay-specific text styles without disturbing the other UI Foundations categories.
- Inserted the startup_screen_large.png screenshot into Visual Hierarchy Step 1 during the early pass, then replaced that raw screenshot box with the actual baked large device-frame asset at /images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-framed.png.
- Matched Visual Hierarchy Steps 1 and 2 to the Original Hero asset width under Iconography & Imagery. Browser measurement confirmed Original Hero, Step 1, and Step 2 all rendered at 318px wide after the final sizing pass.
- Kept Steps 3, 4, and 5 as Small placeholders at the reduced Visual Hierarchy width while Steps 1 and 2 became Large framed devices, preserving the remaining section structure for future visual hierarchy examples.

Work Completed - Muted Focal-Point Asset

- Created a derived PNG from /images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-framed.png at public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-framed-lower-muted.png using sharp.
- Generated and inspected an intermediate transparent-lower-frame variant, then removed it after the user clarified that the full screen should remain visible with selected lower assets at 50% opacity rather than being completely cut away.
- Refined the generated lower-muted asset so the app header, top navigation, hero image, and cheeseboard stay visually present while the lower cream area, sticky cart button, and native bottom orange bar are reduced to 50% opacity.
- Protected the cheeseboard itself during the muting pass after an initial mask also dimmed a few edge pixels around the board. The final mask keeps the focal hero content clear while the lower screen reads as secondary.
- Wired Visual Hierarchy Step 2 to the new lower-muted framed asset while Step 1 uses the fully opaque framed startup image, creating a direct side-by-side comparison between Viewing Area and Focal Point.

Work Completed - TT Fors Annotations

- Added a reusable Visual Hierarchy annotation layer inside the framed image area so explanatory labels sit over the app screen instead of becoming external captions.
- Set Step 1 annotation lines to Viewing and Area, and Step 2 annotation lines to Focal and Point, using the Alla Vostra TT Fors font family already registered in app/globals.css.
- Moved annotation styling inline in ProductFlowSwitcher after the dev server failed to immediately serve a newly added CSS selector, ensuring font family, size, position, and stroke styling applied deterministically.
- Measured the sticky cart button top edge in the framed startup asset and used it as the bottom boundary for vertical placement. The final label center sits at 73.6% of the device-frame height, midway between the lower cream start area and the sticky cart button top.
- Increased both annotation snippets from 28px to 42px, making them 50% larger as requested.
- Changed the Focal Point annotation to white with a black stroke and supporting black text-shadow, while preserving the darker TT Fors treatment for the Viewing Area label.

Work Completed - Snapshot and Commit-Message Context

- Regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt after the work sequence so the snapshot now inventories the new lower-muted framed startup image and records the current c496a04 source commit in recent history.

- Provided the requested commit-message recommendation in the established format: one header followed by hyphen-led change points describing the framed Visual Hierarchy previews, muted lower-screen asset, TT Fors annotations, smaller remaining placeholders, and snapshot refresh.
- Observed that c496a04, Refined portfolio hero and case studies, already contained the ProductFlowSwitcher changes and the new lower-muted asset before this PDF was generated. No additional commit, push, or deployment was performed during the PDF-generation step.

Validation Summary

- npm run check passed with tsc --noEmit after the final Visual Hierarchy annotation and asset work, and again during the August 10 Part 1 worklog-generation pass.
- git diff --check passed after the final snapshot refresh, indicating no trailing-whitespace or whitespace-error issues in the remaining local diff.
- curl -I http://127.0.0.1:3000/projects/alla-vostra returned HTTP 200 from the local Next.js dev server during the final documentation pass.
- Playwright browser checks confirmed Visual Hierarchy Step 1 and Step 2 load the intended framed image assets, render as Large frames, and match the Original Hero width at 318px.
- Playwright browser checks confirmed the annotation lines are Viewing/Area and Focal/Point, use the Alla Vostra TT Fors font stack, render at 42px, remain horizontally centered with zero center offset, and sit at the cart-edge-derived 73.6% vertical placement.
- Playwright screenshot passes were captured during the sizing, lower-muted, and annotation stages to verify the visual state against the actual local page.
- Static export and production deployment were not run during this record because the user asked for the PDF worklog, not a deployment pass.

Files Touched

- app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx - extended PlaceholderScreen to support image-backed frames and annotations, then configured Visual Hierarchy Steps 1 and 2 as framed large-device startup previews with Viewing Area and Focal Point overlays.
- public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-framed-lower-muted.png - added a derived framed startup image where the lower cream area, sticky cart button, and native bottom bar are muted to 50% opacity while the hero content remains the focal layer.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated to reflect the current source tree, recent commit state, public image inventory, and PDF/worklog context after the August 10 work cycle.
- portfolio_worklog_august10_part1.pdf - generated this new root-level PDF worklog artifact following the existing Portfolio naming and structure conventions.

Follow-Up Context

- Visual Hierarchy Steps 3 through 5 still remain placeholder examples and can be filled later with additional hierarchy concepts, but the Step 1 and Step 2 system now establishes the intended device-frame, scale, and annotation language.
- The lower-muted framed asset is derived from the existing Alla Vostra framed startup image. Future changes to the base device frame would require regenerating the muted derivative so both examples stay visually synchronized.
- The Navigation assets that initially looked missing were verified as loading. If they continue to appear too subtle in normal browsing, the likely fix is a visual treatment or cache refresh rather than public asset restoration.

- The local dev server remained available at <http://127.0.0.1:3000> during this work cycle. Public Hostinger deployment was intentionally left untouched.
- As with prior Portfolio work, any future commit or push should still ask the user for the exact commit message before proceeding.

Output Artifact

Generated `portfolio_worklog_august10_part1.pdf` in the Portfolio project root as the latest dated PDF worklog. The artifact follows the established Prahlin Portfolio convention for title format, source-material review, baseline and goals, work-completed sections, validation summary, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.